

Meeting Notes with David Phillips: Director for Strategic Customer Engagement (Accenture), Workday - India PMF research (9 Jan 2025)

Attendee: David Phillips, Director for Strategic Customer Engagement (Accenture), Workday

Topic: Gaps in Workday Recruiting for the Indian market, with Accenture as the primary customer focus.

Summary of Gaps:

1. Lack of robust Blacklisting/Do Not Hire functionality
2. Mass Operations Management for Job Application Purge
3. Limited Auto-Merge Capability (merging >2 duplicate candidates at a time) - Accenture has high volumes (200k) applications
4. Capability to combat Job Application fraud / trickery en masse
5. Absence of ID Validation during the interview process

Key Challenges & Discussion Points:

1. Application Volume & Processing:

- A significant portion (approximately half) of Accenture's applications in India are not currently processed through Workday due to internal compliance reasons.
 - **Action Item:** Clarify if "internal compliance" refers to governmental regulations or Accenture's internal policies.

2. Blacklisting Functionality (Do Not Hire List):

- **Need:** Accenture requires the ability to automatically disposition candidates based on a "Do Not Hire" list due to the high volume of applications. This list includes not only previous employees but also other individuals they wish to flag.
- **Proposed Solution:** Implement a "Do Not Hire" flag within Workday.
- **Broader Applicability:**
 - The Government of Singapore has expressed a similar need for blacklisting individuals (e.g., for departments like Treasury).
 - This functionality could also be valuable for US federal government clients.

3. Auto-Merge Limitations for Duplicate Records:

- **Challenge:** Accenture experiences a high volume of duplicate candidate records (estimated at 200,000) due to the sheer number of applications.
- **Current Limitation:** Workday's auto-merge functionality is currently limited to merging only two records at a time.
- **Need:** Accenture would like the ability to auto-merge more than two duplicate records simultaneously to manage their unique scale efficiently.
- **Context:** Accenture's churn rate and application volume in India are significantly higher than other Workday customers.

4. India Market Specifics & "Trickery":

- **Observation:** The Indian market often seems to be an afterthought in product development.
- **Cultural Factor:** The high number of open positions and intense competition for jobs in India leads to "trickery" from applicants trying to get noticed. This creates a substantial administrative burden to identify and manage these practices, more so than in other regions.
- **Potential Solution:** AI could significantly help in managing the volume and identifying such application behaviors in India.
- **Goal:** The overarching aim is to give hiring managers more time back by streamlining these processes.

5. Transformational Ideas for Recruiting in India:

- **Concept:** Create a Workday-powered professional network, similar to LinkedIn, where employees maintain a validated set of credentials.
 - Candidates could be found and ranked using a "HireScore" algorithm.
 - This would simplify the onboarding process if credentials are pre-verified.
- **Validated Shared Pool:** This network would function as a validated, shared pool of candidates. Once a candidate is hired, their direct link/data within this specific network context might be severed from the broader Workday system (details to be clarified).
- **Monetization Model:**
 - Companies (e.g., Pfizer) would pay a subscription fee to access this network.
 - Employees might also pay a fee to maintain their validated profiles.

6. ID Validation:

- **Need:** Accenture requires functionality to validate that the person being interviewed is indeed the actual candidate.

Overall Theme: The scale of operations and unique market dynamics in India, particularly for a high-volume client like Accenture, present specific challenges and requirements for Workday Recruiting that need to be addressed. The focus is on improving efficiency, managing high volumes, and combating local market behaviors, ultimately freeing up hiring manager time.

